



SmartObjectPlacer

Staff User Guide

Photoshop Smart Object Artwork Placement Tool

VERSION 1.0

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP CC 2025 (V26.X)

WINDOWS

1 Overview

SmartObjectPlacer.jsx is an Adobe Photoshop ExtendScript that automates the placement of artwork into Smart Object layers within print mockup templates. Whether you are working on flyers, brochures, or multi-page booklets, this script handles the repetitive tasks of opening Smart Object layers, clearing existing content, scaling artwork to fit (including bleed extension), and exporting the finished result.

The script saves both a layered **PSD copy** and a flattened **JPG export** to your chosen working directory, allowing you to deliver print-ready files quickly and consistently. A short manual crop step is required after processing (see Section 5).

WHAT THE SCRIPT DOES

Scans Smart Object layers → accepts your artwork (images or PDF pages) → applies bleed scaling → saves PSD + JPG to your working directory.

2 Before You Start — Prerequisites

Ensure all of the following conditions are met before running the script:

Adobe Photoshop CC 2025 (v26.x) must be installed and running on Windows.

Your template PSD must be open in Photoshop before launching the script. The script operates on the currently active document.

Smart Object layers must exist in the template. These are the placeholder layers into which artwork will be placed. Verify by checking for the Smart Object icon on layer thumbnails in the Layers panel.

Artwork files must be ready and accessible: supported formats are     , or .

Know your bleed requirements in millimetres (mm) or pixels (px) before starting. Check with your printer if unsure.

3 How to Run the Script

Follow these steps to launch the SmartObjectPlacer wizard from within Photoshop:

- 1 Open your template PSD file in Photoshop and ensure it is the active document.
- 2 In the menu bar, go to **File → Scripts → Browse...**
- 3 Navigate to the location of **SmartObjectPlacer.jsx** on your system and select it.
- 4 Click **Load** — the wizard dialog will launch immediately.

4 Step-by-Step Walkthrough

The script runs as a guided, multi-step wizard. Follow each step in order. Click **Next** to advance between steps.

1 Project Setup

Enter a **filename** (no file extension needed) — this name will be used for both the saved PSD copy and the JPG export.

Click **Browse** to select a **working directory**. This is the folder where all output files will be saved. Ensure you have write access to the chosen location.

Click **Next** to continue.

2 Smart Object Discovery & Ordering

The script automatically scans all layers and identifies every Smart Object layer in the template, displaying them in layer palette order (top to bottom).

A summary will display: *"Found X Smart Object layer(s)".*

1 Smart Object found: This step is handled automatically — no action required.

Multiple Smart Objects found: You will see a list with an order number field next to each layer name. The default order matches the layer palette. **Change the numbers** if artwork needs to be assigned in a different sequence (for example, booklets where specific pages must go to specific layers).

Click **Next** to continue.

3

Bleed Settings

Enter bleed values for each edge: **Top**, **Bottom**, **Left**, and **Right**. Select the unit — **mm** (default) or **px** — using the dropdown. Leave any field blank or enter for no bleed on that edge.

Bleed causes the artwork to be scaled slightly *larger* than the Smart Object canvas so it extends beyond each edge by the specified amount — this is standard practice for print trim. Check requirements with your printer before entering values.

Click **Next** to continue.

4

Artwork Source Selection

Templates with 1 Smart Object: Select a single image file or a single PDF. If you select a PDF, a follow-up dialog will ask which page to use (displaying the total page count).

Templates with multiple Smart Objects: Choose one of the following sources:

📁 folder of image files — files are sorted by filename and assigned to Smart Objects in your Step 2 order. Name files sequentially (e.g.) to ensure correct assignment.

📄 multi-page PDF file — pages are assigned to Smart Objects in order.

If the number of artwork items does not match the number of Smart Objects, an alert will show both counts. Choose **Continue** to fill what is available, or **Cancel** to stop and adjust your source files.

Click **Next** to continue.

5

Review & Process

A summary of all your settings is displayed for final review. Check that filenames, directories, bleed values, and artwork sources are correct before proceeding.

Click **Process** to begin. A **progress bar** will show the status as each Smart Object is updated in sequence. The script will open each Smart Object, clear existing content, place and scale your artwork (applying bleed), then save and close it before moving to the next.

5 What Happens After Processing

Once processing completes, the script automatically saves the following files to your working directory:

PSD FILE

A full-resolution, layered copy of the template with your artwork placed in all Smart Object layers. This is your editable master file for the job.

JPG EXPORT

A flattened JPG (quality 8/12) saved to the same directory with the same filename. Both files remain open in Photoshop after saving.

MANUAL STEP REQUIRED — CROP THE JPG TO 500 × 500 PX

- Select the **Crop tool** () or go to **Image → Canvas Size**.
- Set the dimensions to **500 × 500 pixels** and confirm.
- Save the cropped JPG **File → Save** or **Ctrl+S**.

IMPORTANT

The 500×500 px crop is a manual step and must be completed before the file can be used for its intended purpose. The script does not perform this crop automatically.

6 Tips & Best Practices

1

Name artwork files sequentially when using folder selection for multi-SO templates (e.g. 01.jpg, 02.jpg, 03.jpg). The script sorts files by filename — sequential naming guarantees correct layer assignment.

2

Confirm bleed requirements with your printer before entering values. Different printers and products have different bleed tolerances — entering incorrect values can cause print defects.

3

Keep template PSDs as clean masters. The script always saves a *copy* — your original template file is never modified. Do not save over your master template manually.

4

For booklets: verify that the Smart Object layer order and your artwork page numbering correspond correctly. Use the ordering step (Step 2) to re-sequence Smart Objects if your layer palette order does not match intended page placement.

5

Artwork proportion mismatch is normal. The script uses “fill” scaling — if your artwork proportions differ from the Smart Object canvas, some cropping at the edges will occur. The flat artwork inside the SO may look stretched; this is expected and will look correct in the parent template.

7

Troubleshooting

If you encounter issues while running the script, refer to the table below.

Issue / Error	Cause & Solution
"No Smart Objects found"	Your template does not contain any Smart Object layers, or they have been rasterised. Open the Layers panel and look for the Smart Object icon (stacked pages) on layer thumbnails. Ask your template creator to restore them.
Script not visible in File → Scripts → Browse	Ensure the file is saved with a <code>.jsx</code> extension. Photoshop will not list files with other extensions as runnable scripts. Check the full filename, including extension.
Artwork looks distorted / stretched inside the Smart Object	This is expected behaviour. Smart Object distortion (perspective, warp) is applied by the <i>parent</i> template. The flat artwork inside the SO layer should look correct once you view the main template, not the SO contents in isolation.

Colour looks incorrect or shifted

The script matches colour modes (RGB/CMYK) between the artwork and the template. Ensure your artwork colour profile matches your template's intended output. Convert profiles in Photoshop if needed before running the script.

"Mismatch" alert — artwork count doesn't match Smart Object count

You have more or fewer artwork files/pages than Smart Objects in the template. Either add or remove artwork files to match the count, then restart, or choose **Continue** in the dialog to fill only the available layers.

NEED FURTHER HELP?

If an issue is not listed above, note the exact error message shown by Photoshop and contact your technical lead with a description of the template and artwork being used.